

Microsoft Office now available for Android phones

Microsoft Office will now be available for Android smartphones. Although it is a pared-down version of the software, the Microsoft Office for Android will not work on Android tablets.



Microsoft Office on Android phones is now available and a user needs to pay a subscription of \$100 a year for it. Office for Android comes after Microsoft launched the same for the iPhone in June. Microsoft is working to make Office 365 a compelling choice. Tablets powered by Microsoft Windows OS (the OS doesn't work on Android tablets) will continue to enjoy their advantage of being able to run Office software with programs like Word, PowerPoint and Excel.

According to a company blog post, "The release of this app shows that we're committed to keep providing additional value for Office 365 subscribers. Office 365 subscribers will now be able to access, view, and edit Word, Excel and PowerPoint documents with Windows Phone, iPhone and Android phones."

Microsoft Office for Android smartphones is lightweight and easy to use. People can use it to view and edit a doc sent by email, but using it for creating a complex spreadsheet from scratch should be difficult. The new software will work on devices running Android 4.0 or later. It is available through Google's online Play Store. It will initially be available only in the US, but the company has plans to take it to 117 markets across the globe in over 30 languages.

and is designed to be a talking companion for Koichi Wakata, one of the astronauts working in the ISS. Just 34 cm tall and 1 kg in weight, the robot, which is named Kirobo, is programmed to converse in Japanese and record the conversations it has with Wakata, who is also the first Japanese astronaut to command the ISS.

Kirobo's creator, Tomotaka Takahashi was quoted as saying, "Kirobo will remember Mr Wakata's face, so it can recognise him when they reunite up in space. He will be the first robot to visit the space station."

The robot is capable of a wide range of physical movements and is expected to play vital roles in some of the missions, during which it will relay messages from the control room to the astronaut. Also, back here on earth, its twin robot, Mirata, will be looking out for any problems that its electronic counterpart might face.



Linux Foundation launches two new courses for developers

The Linux Foundation is now changing its view about developers. The non-profit organisation is of the opinion that Linux developers are no more mere developers. Their role is changing and this fact has led to expanding the training options to help them.

The foundation has introduced

two new courses as a part of its training—OpenStack Cloud Architecture and Deployment, and Linux Enterprise Automation. These days, with cloud technology flourishing, developers are increasingly working with cloud systems and automation technologies. The new courses will help developers work in these agile development environments and reflect these changing trends, said Amanda McPherson, the vice president of marketing and developer programs at the Foundation.

The newly-introduced training programs aim at mastering technologies like the automation tool, Puppet, and the management system, SpaceWalk.



This supercomputer has 160 TB of RAM and 57,472 cores!

Meet Raijin, the latest supercomputer around. So why are we talking about it? Well, we talk about everything that astonishes us and this supercomputer has 160 TB RAM and 57,472 cores. Needless to say, it is one of the top supercomputers today.

Raijin has its origins in Australia, but the name comes from the Japanese God of thunder, lightning and storms. It can operate at a speed of up to 1200 trillion calculations per second. Despite being so powerful, it lags behind the Chinese Tianhe-2, which can perform over 33,860 trillion calculations per second like a pro. Raijin's operational speed ranks it at the 27th spot in the world. It was ranked #24 during the tests.

